

Suggested Bibliography for A Grammar of Agency

Organized by thematic categories for clarity and future formation use.

I. Catholic Social Teaching & Ecclesial Anthropology

Core CST Sources

- *Compendium of the Social Doctrine of the Church* — Pontifical Council for Justice and Peace
- *Gaudium et Spes* — Vatican II
- *Laudato Si'* — Pope Francis
- *Fratelli Tutti* — Pope Francis
- *Caritas in Veritate* — Benedict XVI
- *Centesimus Annus* — John Paul II
- *Sollicitudo Rei Socialis* — John Paul II

Anthropology & Moral Life

- Servais Pinckaers, *The Sources of Christian Ethics*
- Josef Pieper, *The Four Cardinal Virtues*
- Romano Guardini, *The Virtues*
- Charles Taylor, *Sources of the Self*

Dominican & Thomistic Resonances

- Thomas Aquinas, *Summa Theologiae* (esp. I-II on virtue and actus humanus)
- Thomas Joseph White, *The Light of Christ*
- Herbert McCabe, *Law, Love and Language*

II. Virtue Ethics & Practical Wisdom (Prudential Praxis)

Classical & Neo-Aristotelian

- Aristotle, *Nicomachean Ethics*
- Alasdair MacIntyre, *After Virtue*

- Alasdair MacIntyre, *Whose Justice? Which Rationality?*
- Martha Nussbaum, *The Fragility of Goodness*

Modern Virtue Ethics

- Julia Annas, *Intelligent Virtue*
- Rosalind Hursthouse, *On Virtue Ethics*
- Linda Zagzebski, *Virtues of the Mind*

Practical Wisdom & Decision-Making

- Barry Schwartz & Kenneth Sharpe, *Practical Wisdom*
- Hubert Dreyfus & Stuart Dreyfus, *Mind over Machine* (expertise & embodied judgment)

III. Phenomenology, Embodiment & the Moment of Actus

Phenomenological Foundations

- Maurice Merleau-Ponty, *Phenomenology of Perception*
- Edmund Husserl, *Ideas 1*
- Max Scheler, *Formalism in Ethics and Non-Formal Ethics of Values*

Action, Agency & Embodied Judgment

- Hubert Dreyfus, *Skillful Coping*
- Shaun Gallagher, *Action and Interaction*
- Charles Taylor, *The Explanation of Behaviour*

Witnessing, Presence & the Field

- Martin Buber, *I and Thou*
- Romano Guardini, *The Art of Praying* (for the vertical axis)
- Jean-Luc Marion, *Being Given*

IV. Systems Thinking, Influence, and Field Dynamics

Systems & Complexity

- Donella Meadows, *Thinking in Systems*

- Peter Senge, *The Fifth Discipline*
- Edgar Schein, *Organizational Culture and Leadership*

Power, Influence & Fields

- Pierre Bourdieu, *Outline of a Theory of Practice*
- Michel Foucault, *Discipline and Punish* (for influence structures)
- Kurt Lewin, *Field Theory in Social Science*

Moral Ecology

- Shannon Vallor, *Technology and the Virtues*
- Shannon Vallor, *The AI Mirror*
- Albert Borgmann, *Technology and the Character of Contemporary Life*

V. Discernment, Formation & Spiritual Praxis

Discernment Traditions

- Ignatius of Loyola, *Spiritual Exercises*
- Timothy Gallagher, *The Discernment of Spirits*
- Henri Nouwen, *Discernment*

Formation & Agency

- Dallas Willard, *The Spirit of the Disciplines*
- James K.A. Smith, *Desiring the Kingdom*
- Eugene Peterson, *A Long Obedience in the Same Direction*

Silence, Restraint & Wu Wei

- Lao Tzu, *Tao Te Ching*
- Thomas Merton, *New Seeds of Contemplation*
- Thich Nhat Hanh, *The Miracle of Mindfulness*

VI. Leadership, Judgment & Moral Action in the World

Judgment & Decision

- Hannah Arendt, *Responsibility and Judgment*

- Jonathan Lear, *Radical Hope*
- Michael Polanyi, *Personal Knowledge*

Leadership as Agency

- Ronald Heifetz, *Leadership Without Easy Answers*
- Edwin Friedman, *A Failure of Nerve*
- Margaret Wheatley, *Leadership and the New Science*

VII. Bonus: Books That Echo the Grammar Without Knowing It

These aren't "sources" — they're resonant texts that mirror the architecture:

1. Viktor Frankl — *Man's Search for Meaning*

A field manual for the vertical axis under maximal load.

Frankl shows what happens when the sail catches the wind in the darkest possible field.

2. Matthew Crawford — *Shop Class as Soulcraft*

A love letter to embodied agency.

Crawford names the dignity of actus better than most philosophers.

3. David Brooks — *The Second Mountain*

A map of the shift from first-tier autonomy to second-tier vocation.

Brooks stumbles into the vertical axis without knowing the term.

4. James Clear — *Atomic Habits*

Micro-praxis, stabilizers, and the physics of drift.

Clear is basically writing about roll, pitch, and the small moves that keep the craft upright.

5. Edwin Friedman — *A Failure of Nerve*

A treatise on field stability.

Friedman reads systemic disturbance with the eye of a seasoned Witness.

6. Annie Dillard — *Teaching a Stone to Talk*

Moments of actus rendered in prose.

Dillard sees the world the way an operator sees a moment: charged, precise, alive.

7. Michael Polanyi — *Personal Knowledge*

A defense of tacit knowing — the keel beneath expertise.

Polanyi explains why the vertical axis can't be automated.

8. James K.A. Smith — *Desiring the Kingdom*

Formation as habit, habit as identity, identity as agency.

Smith names the slow, stabilizing work beneath the Four Moves.

9. Thich Nhat Hanh — *The Miracle of Mindfulness*

Wu wei in a monastic key.

The timing belt rendered as breath, presence, and proportion.

10. Cormac McCarthy — *The Road*

A novel about the Witness Moment repeated across a wasteland.

The father's actus is the vertical axis walking.